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What is a super agent?

A normal AI agent is like an intern at your desk: you open it, ask, and watch it work. A super agent is like a teammate in your group chat: it picks up the work and comes back done. On 31 October 2026, DeepSeek open-sourced one. This guide explains the idea, how DeepSeek's version works, and what teams could use it for.

MIT
open-source licence

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R&D
a research prototype, not an official product

The one-line idea

Instead of you going to the AI, the AI sits where your team already works, picks up requests, and reports back in the same place.

In this guide

- Normal agent vs super agent, side by side
- How DeepSeek's Super-Agent works, step by step
- What's under the hood: DeepSeek Harness
- What a team could use one for
- Before you try it, and how to try it
- Words you'll hear (glossary)

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Normal agent vs super agent

	🧑‍💻 Normal agent	🦸 Super agent
WHERE IT LIVES	An app or window you open	Your team's chat and code repository
WHO STARTS WORK	You, every time	Requests from approved people, or rules your team sets
HOW YOU WORK WITH IT	You watch and steer it step by step	You get the result back in the thread
WHAT IT RETURNS	An answer or code in the chat window	A reply in the original thread, often a pull request
YOUR ATTENTION	High: it needs you the whole time	Low: a panel shows only what needs a human
ANALOGY	An intern sitting at your desk	A teammate in the group chat

Why it matters

The bottleneck in most teams isn't typing code; it's people's attention. DeepSeek's stated goal is exactly that: **"Take as little human attention as possible, and give as much value as possible."**

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DeepSeek's Super-Agent, step by step

💬 1. A request comes in
From the team's GitHub repository or, optionally, Feishu (ByteDance's workplace chat). Work starts only from an authorised person's request or a rule the team has set: it's event-driven, not an AI running loose on its own.

🚦 2. A router checks it
The router evaluates incoming requests and lets permitted ones through as work items.

🛠️ 3. A worker does the task
Each accepted work item runs in its own isolated agent session and its own directory, so tasks don't step on each other.

✅ 4. The result comes back
The agent replies in the original thread, for a code task often with a pull request your team can review.

👀 5. A panel for humans
A web panel lists only the work that needs human attention, so people check what matters instead of watching everything.

Example

Priya posts "the login page is broken again" in the team chat. The router sees she's an approved requester, a worker investigates in its own session, and a pull request with a fix appears in the same thread for review.

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Built on DeepSeek Harness

Super-Agent is a worked example built on DeepSeek Harness ("dsh"), an open-source agent framework DeepSeek launched on 13 August 2026. Startup Fortune describes the release as "shipping the plumbing" so others can build their own super agents.

Model adapters talk to LLMs	**Tools** what it can do	**Sessions** one per task	**Sandboxes** where work runs
Storage state and files	**Agent loops** how it thinks and acts	**Interface** web UI	**Cordis** plugin runtime underneath

Why plugins matter

Harness runs on Cordis, a plugin runtime that can add components at runtime and undo their effects when they're removed. Every part above is a plugin, so a team can swap the model, add a tool or change the interface without rewriting the agent.

188K+

GitHub stars on Harness (177,904 in its first 8 days)

2

repositories, both MIT-licensed

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What could a team use one for?

Ideas for the kind of work a super agent fits: well-defined requests that end in something a human can review.

🐞 Bug reports → fixes

A bug posted in chat comes back as a pull request with a fix to review.

📦 Dependency updates

"Upgrade library X" turns into a PR with the change and test results.

🧪 Failing tests

A red build gets investigated and a likely fix is proposed.

📝 Docs that drift

A merged change triggers a docs update in the same repository.

🔎 "Where is this in the code?"

Questions in chat answered with file links, in the thread.

🧹 Small chores

Renames, config changes, typo fixes: the tasks nobody wants.

Where it fits less well

Vague requests ("make it better"), big design decisions, and anything that needs judgement about people or priorities. Those still need a human in the loop.

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What DeepSeek says about it

- **It's a research prototype**, "not an official DeepSeek product": reference code to learn from and build on.
- **Not production-ready.** Some ideas from DeepSeek's design article aren't in the published code yet.
- **Expect breaking changes** while it's experimental.
- DeepSeek advises reviewing plugins and generated commands and running it with minimal privileges.

How to try Harness locally

- ☐ Install a supported version of Node.js
- ☐ Run **npx @deepseek-ai/dsh web**
- ☐ Open the local UI at 127.0.0.1:3080
- ☐ For Super-Agent, read the README in deepseek-ai/dsh-superagent-prototype on GitHub first

Sources

The Next Web: thenextweb.com/news/deepseek-super-agent-open-source-coding-agent
Startup Fortune: startupfortune.com/deepseek-open-sources-the-architecture-behind-its-super-agent
Bloomberg (via TNW) reports DeepSeek is aiming it at Claude Code.

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Words you'll hear

AI agent
An AI that can take actions (run code, call tools), not just answer.

Super agent
An agent that lives where the team works, picks up requests and reports back, needing as little human attention as possible.

Router
The part that checks incoming requests and decides which become work items.

Worker / session
An isolated run of the agent for one task, with its own directory.

Pull request (PR)
A proposed code change that people review before it's merged.

Harness
The framework that holds an agent together: model, tools, sessions, sandboxes, storage.

Plugin
A part you can add or remove without rewriting the rest.

Open source (MIT)
Free to use, change and share, including commercially.

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